

PFM 209 Course Outline

PFM 209 — Integrated FINEX–MTEF–Budget Analysis

Course Outline

School	02 — Macroeconomics and Public Finance
Level	200 (analyst / practitioner)
Hours	30 (indicative band 24–32)
Shape	5 modules · 10 sessions · 6 laboratories · 4 assignments · 1 final assessment
Delivery	Instructor-led — online, blended or in person
Prerequisites	The six preceding modules of School 02. This is the capstone and it assumes them: MAC 202 for the scenario suite, PFM 203 for the medium-term framework, PFM 204 for the budget warehouse, PFM 205 for the coefficient service, PFM 206 for the conversion run, PFM 207 for the composition and rigidity decomposition, and PFM 208 for the risk reading.
Assessment	Pass 60 %, with 60 % laboratory competency
Version	1.0 · reviewed 2026-08-25 · 12-month cycle

What this course is

PFM 209 is the capstone of School 02. It derives nothing. Every figure it states was produced by one of the six preceding courses and is read here from their published extracts, consolidated once.

Its claim is threefold: that the chain agrees with itself; that where it does not agree the disagreement is nameable to the dollar; and that a handful of findings exist only when the seven modules are read together. The first is demonstrated by a control total — 84.392 tn — recorded by five modules, 3 of them exactly, with a spread of 43,343,311 dollars that is entirely decimal rounding at publication.

The claim, stated once. The chain agrees with itself. Every module that records the approved budget records 84.392 tn. Three of the five record it to the dollar; the other two differ only because their published tables round trillions.

Who it is for

Analysts who have to answer a question that crosses more than one system: macro-fiscal and budget directorate staff preparing an integrated brief; planning and policy units reconciling a medium-term

framework with an appropriation; reviewers and oversight bodies who receive integrated analyses and need to know what to check; and modelling teams whose outputs are read by somebody else's model.

What this course does not claim

This course derives no new figure. Where a number here differs from a number in one of the six preceding courses, the preceding course is right and this one has a bug.

Structure

Module	Title	Sessions	Laboratory	Hours
M1	The chain, and what integration means	01–02	01	5.2
M2	Reading the chain forward	03–05	02	8.3
M3	The six questions	06–08	03, 05–06	8.8
M4	The six findings	09	04	2.6
M5	Where the chain breaks	10	06	2.1
ASM	Assessment and revision	—	—	3.0
	Total	10	6	30.0

The 10 sessions and 6 laboratories, in teaching order, and the subject matter of each:

M1 The chain, and what integration means — Sessions 01–02 · 5.2 h · Laboratory 01

- **01 The chain, and the number that proves it** — the question this course exists to answer; the seven modules and what each one is for; what a chain is, and why it is not a pipeline; the control total: one number, five modules
- *Lab 01 Prove the chain agrees* — establish for yourself, from five separate extracts, that every module in the chain records the same budget — and characterise the difference where two of them do not
- **02 Handovers, refusals and the reporting contract** — the ten handovers; one refusal discipline, seven implementations; the reporting contract for an integrated finding; the six questions the chain can answer, and more

M2 Reading the chain forward — Sessions 03–05 · 8.3 h · Laboratory 02

- **03 Reading the chain forward: envelope, ceilings, appropriation** — FINEX to MTEF — the envelope; MTEF to Budget — ceilings and forward estimates; budget to Crosswalk — the classified line
- *Lab 02 Walk a number backwards* — take a figure from a finding and trace it, step by step, to a hashed source document
- **04 Conversion: the crosswalk, the coefficient, the refusal** — crosswalk to BOE — the conversion mode; UCSN to BOE — a coefficient, or a refusal; BOE to MTEF — the future recurrent requirement
- **05 Closing the loop, and walking a number backwards** — BOE to CDCGE — government demand as shocks; BOE to MEL — delivered outputs and their uncertainty; MEL to UCSN — evidence becomes a coefficient; BOE to FINEX — closing the loop, and more

M3 The six questions — Sessions 06–08 · 8.8 h · Laboratory 03, 05–06

- **06 Q1 and Q2 — consistency, and what the budget buys** — method: how to work a question across modules; Q1 — Is the medium-term plan consistent with the approved budget?; Q2 — What does the budget actually buy?
- *Lab 03 Reproduce F-01 from the MTEF tables* — establish independently that the MTEF assesses a maintenance shortfall it does not carry into its funding-gap table
- **07 Q3 and Q4 — what is spoken for, and what if the macro is wrong** — Q3 — How much of next year is already spoken for?; Q4 — What if the macro assumptions are wrong?
- *Lab 05 Absorb a shock* — express a macro scenario in the terms an accounting officer works in
- **08 Q5 and Q6 — the largest exposure, and the best acquisition** — Q5 — Where is the largest measurable exposure?; Q6 — What single acquisition would improve the most answers?; what the chain cannot answer at all
- *Lab 06 Build the acquisition programme* — assemble every refusal in the chain into a ranked acquisition case

M4 The six findings — Session 09 · 2.6 h · Laboratory 04

- **09 The six cross-course findings** — what makes a finding a cross-course finding; F-01 — The MTEF assesses a maintenance shortfall it does not carry into the gap; F-02 — The development vote is not an investment..., and more
- *Lab 04 The development vote against what it forms* — establish that the development appropriation is not an investment programme, and quantify by how much

M5 Where the chain breaks — Session 10 · 2.1 h · Laboratory 06

- **10 The honest account, and the integrated brief** — the refusal register; seven refusals, one rule; the acquisition programme; what this course does not claim, and more

What a graduate can do

1. Name the seven modules of the chain and state what each produces and what it hands on.
2. Distinguish a chain from a pipeline, and say why the difference determines how failures are found.
3. Reconcile a control total across five modules and attribute any apparent difference to the dollar.
4. Distinguish internal consistency from accuracy, and refuse to present the first as the second.
5. State what a declared handover carries, and identify an undeclared one.
6. State the refusal rule and recognise its seven implementations across the estate.
7. Write an integrated finding that satisfies the eight-element reporting contract.
8. Walk a figure backwards to a source identified by hash, and name the weakest step.
9. Distinguish a ceiling, a forward estimate and an appropriation, and compare only what is comparable.
10. Read a conversion result as a governance state rather than a measurement.

The 16 formal learning outcomes, and the map from each to the assessment that tests it, are in 12_LMS/learning_outcomes.md.

Assessment

Component	Weight	What it is
Knowledge quizzes	15 %	86 items across 10 modules

Component	Weight	What it is
Laboratory exercises	30 %	6 laboratories, equally weighted, marked on method, interpretation, honesty about limits and communication
Applied assignments	25 %	prove the chain, and trace a number; reproduce a cross-course finding; the development vote, and the shock it must absorb; the integrated brief and its acquisition programme
Final assessment	30 %	Three hours, open book: the chain and its contracts; calculation; interpretation; reporting

Pass 60 % overall and 60 % laboratory competency. Merit 70 %. Distinction 80 %. One resubmission of a single failed component within eight weeks. A laboratory is not complete until every validation check has been recorded with its actual value: an unchecked result is no result.

Materials and set-up

A 121-page technical manual; 10 lecture decks and 6 laboratory decks; a laboratory manual, instructor guide and learner workbook; a 86-item quiz bank, 4 assignments and a final assessment with its marking guide; 16 datasets; 5 code exercises; 6 case studies; and the lms package. The README lists every file.

Every figure in this course is traceable to a published source or a committed model output; the sources are registered in `COURSE_VERSION.json` and the limitations in `COURSE_BUILD_REPORT.md`. Laboratories need only the extracts shipped in `08_Data/`.

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